



Ethical AI turns racist

Scientists built an AI to give ethical advice, but it turned out to be super racist. <https://digit.in/nov21-33>



MS Teams to join Metaverse race

Microsoft Teams enters the metaverse race with 3D avatars and immersive meetings. <https://digit.in/nov21-34>

AlloDoc doctor, the portal the doctor can view the pregnant mother's data. The doctor's feedback will be shared with the husband over the call and notification. The next day, based on the doctors feedback, the health workers provide tablets and nutrition to the pregnant mother. High-risk mothers will be taken to the rural hospital for follow up checkup."

Finally, we asked about the experience of working with riidl, "we have been part of the riidl for the past 3 years. The support we are getting from riidl is helping us reach our milestones."

PURIFYING WATER

Inphlox water systems makes modular systems for purifying rainwater. We spoke to Amrit Om Nayak, Co-Founder and CEO about the startup. The development of the systems actually have a long history. Amrit tells us, "we had built prototypes for stormwater purification and greywater recycling as part of an Environmental Innovation Challenge while doing our Master's at the University of Washington, Seattle. Encouraged by successful results, we continued our research and development in physio-electrical process technology for water treatment. Our innovation makes micro-electrolysis commercially feasible while achieving significant improvements in process efficiency, electrode shelf life, dynamic process control, and reduction in energy consumption. Our innovation is a broad spectrum pollution removal mechanism and is very effective in handling shock loads and variations." One of the most innovative things about the technology is that it uses zero harmful chemicals in the whole process. We asked Amrit about the rationale behind making this choice, "large-scale uncontrolled use of chemicals has a very damaging effect on the environment. It has a massive carbon footprint



The Allotricorder

and also results in the generation of tonnes of toxic sludge. Chemically driven processes require high retention time and struggle to provide consistent output due to inherent weaknesses in the face of variable load and human error. This also results in smell and colour in the output water, thereby making it unsuitable for reuse. We want to change this and help the world quickly adopt sustainable technologies." The entire system is wired up

and connected, making it smart as well as sustainable. Amrit explains, "all Indra systems are enabled with SMART automation, which helps in reducing human errors while treatment. The systems can be remotely controlled and monitored for performance. The system can optimize electricity consumption based on the quality of raw water thereby reducing operational costs." When asked about the future plans for the company, Amrit tells

us, "we have a strong order pipeline and are focusing on executing the projects successfully. We'll be installing 5 systems PAN India in the next 5 months. We've just closed a strategic investment round and are scaling up our engineering team and operations aggressively. We're a technology-first company and will keep building great tech for a sustainable future."

HI TECH NACHOS

Nachos are typically made from fried or baked corn. Beaniesnak, however, had the innovative idea of making a healthy, high protein snack, and making nachos from beans. The idea was to go beyond making baked healthy snacks, but one that provided a healthy dose of nutrition. We spoke to Ankit Raj, one of the founders of Beaniesnak about how the company came to be. Ankit told us, "Always aiming to be a businessman, I did MBA to learn the business. Sayli (the other founder) got the idea of

making a nutrition snack during her MSc Nutraceuticals final year project. This leads us to look for the best ingredients that are rich in protein while less consumed by mass. We took a challenge to turn beans into chips which led us to a vision of making them more nutritious than just healthy snacks." Beaniesnak has ambitious plans for scaling the snacks that they have developed, making it a household staple. When asked what kind of problem Beaniesnak is trying to solve, Ankit explains, "there is an unavailability of healthy snacks to mass. Health snack brands target and serve premium customers through premium locations, at higher prices. The mass segment has to settle for any kind of unhealthy chips." We then asked about the high tech manufacturing process of the company, where all the magic of converting beans to nachos takes place. Ankit tells us, "the manufacturing facility is owned by another manufacturer on which we developed the commercial product through various trials and planning to import lab-scale machinery available in the USA for better quality which can be replicated to increase production capacity. (This machine will produce any kind of gluten-free chips)". When asked about the future plans of the company, Ankit tells us, "We are currently working on whey chips and egg white chips that will contain 40% protein in a pack. We have started working on puff-based snacks and planning to expand the product line. We are available on Amazon and other marketplaces along with our website serving pan India and will be looking towards foreign trade within 2 years." Finally, we asked about the experience of working with riidl, "whatever we are now is definitely because of our efforts but it wouldn't have been possible without riidl. We knew nothing about startup/business before we were here where we got experts, mentoring, funds to kickstart, space to work and even a network of 39,000 customers in Somaiya Vidyavihar University where we can promote, test and validate our products." **d**